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The Best Budget Apps for 2025

NerdWallet's editorial team evaluated a wide range of budgeting apps based on features, user reviews, and usability to identify top options for 2025. Our recommendations include tools tailored for individuals, couples, and wealth tracking

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+ 2 more 

Basic budget apps typically connect with your financial accounts, track spending and categorize expenses so you can see where your money is going. But the best budget apps do much more.

NerdWallet's editorial team assessed budget app features and user reviews to arrive at top choices for you to consider. See our full methodology at the bottom of the page.

Monarch Money, for customized budgeting

Monarch Money made the cut thanks to its robust lineup of features and customizable budgeting tools that are great for singles or couples — you can add a household member to the subscription at no extra charge.

Monarch allows you to sync bank accounts, credit cards, loans and investments. After syncing, users choose between two budgeting strategies: flex, the default option, and category.

Flex budgeting is a high-level view. It shows three buckets: your fixed expenses, non-monthly recurring expenses (like insurance premiums and kids activity fees) and flexible expenses, which includes all the dining out and shopping — in a single

view, which prompts users to set limits for purchases.

Worth tracker, investment dashboard,

personalized reports and reminders of upcoming bills. The collaboration tools also set the app apart. You

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Popular budget apps, according to Reddit users

As soon as you get paid, you tell YNAB how much of your income should go toward various categories, including spending, savings and debt. The idea is that you become more intentional with your money when you're prompted to actively decide what to do with it.

With all this decision making, the YNAB app is a hands-on way to budget money. To help users trek up that learning curve, YNAB's website offers many educational resources describing exactly how to budget and use the app.

YNAB allows you to link your checking and savings accounts, as well as credit cards and loans. Or you can opt out of syncing your accounts and manually add or import your transactions, if you would prefer.

The app also features a loan payoff simulator, as well as the "YNAB Together" function. The latter is designed for partners, parents, caregivers or other close connections. It allows up to five users to share a membership.

The app works on mobile, desktop, iPad and Apple Watch.

Why you may want to think twice



Cost



Ratings



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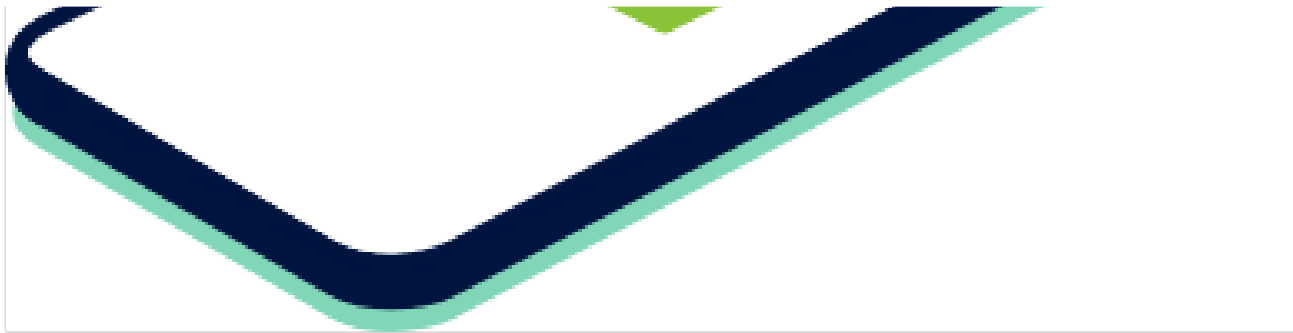
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Goodbudget, for hands-on envelope budgeting

Goodbudget is more about planning your finances than tracking previous transactions. This app is based on the [envelope budgeting](#) system, in which you portion out your monthly income toward specific spending categories (called envelopes).

The free version doesn't connect to your bank accounts. You manually add account balances (that you can pull from your bank's website), as well as cash amounts, debts and income. Then you assign money to envelopes.

That free version allows one account, two devices and limited envelopes.

The paid version, Goodbudget Premium, allows unlimited envelopes and accounts, up to five devices and other perks. You can also link checking, savings and credit accounts to allow automatic tracking.

I also find many helpful articles and videos related to budgeting, paying off debt and more.



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» We tried this app. See our [Empower Personal Dashboard review](#)

PocketGuard, for a budget snapshot

PocketGuard is another app that follows the zero-based budgeting framework.

Start by connecting your credit, checking and savings accounts. Then provide your monthly income and spending categories, such as rent or mortgage, utilities, groceries and transportation costs.

With that intel, the app shows a detailed view at your incoming and outgoing cash flow. It also shows how much you have left to spend after setting aside money for necessities, bills and savings goals.

You can now customize how your transactions are categorized — and you can do it in bulk, rather than manually changing categories one by one (Note: there are limits on how many times free users can do this).

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to sync investment accounts, track

a debt payoff plan and a tool designed to

Watch.

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Honeydue also sends reminders for upcoming bills and lets you chat and send emojis.

Why you may want to think twice



Cost



Ratings



» We tried this app. [See our Honeydue review](#)

EveryDollar, for simple zero-based budgeting

Everydollar, designed by personal finance expert Dave Ramsey's company Ramsey Solutions, offers another zero-based budgeting framework.

Let's start with the free version of the EveryDollar app. You don't sync accounts, but rather manually enter incoming and outgoing money throughout the month. You also categorize line items in your budget.

The paid version of EveryDollar includes those features and allows you to connect your bank account. Your transactions automatically appear in the app, which also provides custom reports and

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- **Monarch Money** garners positive reviews and is often cited as a good replacement for users of the now defunct Mint app.
- **Copilot** (an app we haven't reviewed yet) gets mentioned multiple times as a good option that's only available to Apple users.
- **Google Sheets and Excel** come up consistently as a free and customizable way to make a budget.

Are budget apps secure?

Aggregators and your data



Methodology to identify the best budget apps

How we came up with the list



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